INCH-POUND

A-A-886A
November 5, 1992
SUPERSEDING
A-A-886
March 10, 1981

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

TOWELS, BATH, (TERRY)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description in preference to DDD-T-551K.

Classification The towels shall be in the following types, classes and styles:

Type I - Single loop

Class 1 - 20 by 40 inches
Class 2 - 22 by 44 inches
Class 3 - 16 by 27 inches
Class 4 - 24 by 50 inches

Type II - Double loop

Class 1 - 22 by 44 inches
Class 2 - 16 by 27 inches
Class 4 - 20 by 27 inches

Style A - Selvage edge both sides
Style B - One selvage edge, one hemmed edge
Style C - Hemmed edge both sides

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Defense Personnel Support Center, Clothing and Textiles Directorate, Attn: DPSC-FSSD, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19101-8419, by using the Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 7210

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Salient Characteristics. This commercial item description covers the requirements for cotton terry-cloth towels. The towels shall be bleached white or dyed, as specified. The cloth shall consist of warp and filling ground yarns and warp pile yarns, woven with a terry weave. When specified, each towel shall be marked "US" in 1 inch block letters in a black medium to be centered in the border on one end of the towel. The "US" marking shall conform to type IV, class 9 of DDD-L-20.

Material. The ground warp and filling yarns for all Types and sizes of towels, except the Type I, 24 X 50 inch towel, shall be cotton or polyester/cotton which may contain up to 70% polyester with the remaining percentage cotton. The pile warp yarns shall be 100% cotton which has been spun into singles yarn. The overall fiber content of the Type I, 24 X 50 inch towel shall be 100% cotton The thread for hemming shall conform to the requirements of A-A-52094. The thread size for end hems shall be ticket No. 40, 3 ply or ticket No. 50, 3 ply The thread sizes for the side hem (styles B and C only) shall be ticket No 50, 3 ply for the needle thread and ticket No. 70, 2 ply or ticket No 50, 3 ply for the looper thread The color of the thread shall match the color of the towel. A textured nylon thread having a breaking strength of 4 4 pounds minimum and 10,000 yards per pound minimum may be used as an alternate thread for the 401 stitch. The color of the thread shall match the color of the towel.

Label A commercial type label is acceptable The commercial label shall include fiber content information.

Sizes and Measurements. The finished borders, selvages, and hems shall conform to the measurements below.

Table I. Borders Without Terry Loops 1/

	Width(in)	Distance From Towel Edge At Each End
Type I	1 to 2-1/2 ± 1/2	3-1/2 ± 1/2
Type II	1 to 2-1/2 ± 1/2	3-1/2 ± 1/2

1/ A woven border at the end hem, up to 3/4 inch wide, is permissible.

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Table II. Selvages

	Weave(in)	Min Width(in)	Max Width(in)
Style A	3 X 3 rib or terry weave	1/4	3/8
Style B	3 X 3 rib or terry weave	1/4	3/8

Table III. End Hems

Stitch Type	Hem Width	Stitch Dist From Turned Edge	Stitches Per Inch	Seam Type
301 1/	1/4 to 3/8	1/16 to 1/8	8 to 12	EFb-1 3/
401 2/	1/4 to 3/8	1/16 to 1/8	8 to 12	EFb-1 3/

1/ The hem sewn with the 301 stitch shall be backstitched at least 1/2 inch, at the beginning and ends of the stitching.
2/ For the 401 stitch, a stitching chain 1/4 to 1/2 inch length shall be left at the first and last ends of the stitching or the stitches for the first and last 1/4 inch may be gathered at the rate of 14 to 16 stitches per inch.
3/ Seam Type from FED-STD-751.

Table IV. Side Hems

	No. of Sides With Border	Width of Border	Seam Type	Hem Width	Stitch Margin	Stitches per Inch
Style B	1	3/4	EFb-1	1/4 to 3/8	3/16 to 1/4	8 to 10
Style C	2	3/4	EFb-1	1/4 to 3/8	3/16 to 1/4	8 to 10

Workmanship The finished towel shall conform to the quality and grade of product established by this commercial item description

Product Demonstration Model. When required, offerers shall submit samples of their intended production. The Product Demonstration Model will consist of units independently developed. Product Demonstration Models will be analyzed and evaluated by the government. Evaluation criteria and basis for award are contained in the solicitation. Product Demonstration Models will be retained by the government. One (1) Product Demonstration Model approved by DPSC under the resultant contract will serve as a manufacturing standard for the corresponding

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production items delivered under this contract Offerers are advised that the Product Demonstration Model does not relieve the successful offerer of his responsibility to perform in accordance with the Commercial Item Description specified above

Quality Assurance

Certification The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and that the product conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards and quality assurance practices. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to the first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for, under the provisions of the contract Reliance on contractor QA systems shall not relieve the contractor of the responsibility of ensuring that all products or supplies submitted to the government for acceptance comply with all requirements of the contract.

Examination Towels lots shall be inspected in accordance with "Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes", ANSI/ASQC Z1 4, published by the American Society for Quality Control.

Visual Examination The towels shall be examined for the defects listed below The lot size shall be expressed in units of towels The sample unit is one towel The inspection level shall be I and the acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2 5.

Defects. The towels shall be examined for the following defects: any hole, cut, tear, color not as specified; any spot or stain (outside); thread ends not removed; label missing, incorrect, or illegible; measurement of item not as specified; broken or missing ground warp or filling yarn; fine or light filling bar, light place; wrong draw or reed mark; selvage missing, cut torn, scalloped, curled, rolled, or folded; terry loops missing in combined directions or not formed properly; terry pile caught in side hem; objectionable odor; any trash, motes, leaf, or seed coat fragments; wrong seam or stitch type; stitching margins not as required; loose tension, resulting in loosely secured hem; tight tension (stitches break when normal strain is applied to seam); stitches per inch not as specified; open seam; raw edge; needle chew resulting in hole; thread color not as required; backstitching at end of hem omitted (for 301 stitching); end of hem stitching not secured as specified (for 401 stitch); hem omitted at end of towel; hem twisted, pleated, or puckered; width of hem at each end not as specified; width of side hem not as

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specified; width of selvage not as specified; design or marking not accomplished as specified; design or lettering omitted, incomplete, illegible, incorrect, wrong color, or misplaced.

Dimensional Examination. The finished towel shall conform to the dimensions specified. Any dimension that is not within the established tolerance shall be classified as a defect. The sample unit shall be one towel; the inspection level shall be S-3 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5.

Packaging Examination. The fully packaged shipping containers shall be examined in accordance with defects listed below. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5.

EXAMINE	DEFECT
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, or method of application
Materials	Any component missing, damaged, or not as specified
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as: incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, improper taping, or inadequate stapling
Content	Number of items in container is more or less than required
	NSN shown on one or more items not as specified on shipping container
Palletization	Length, width, or height exceeds specified maximum requirements
	Pallet type not as specified
	Load not bonded as specified

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Regulatory Requirements. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practicable.

End Item Performance Testing The color of dyed or bleached towels shall match the standard sample under natural (north sky) daylight or artificial daylight having a color temperature of 7500 ± 500 Kelvin and shall be a good approximation to the standard sample under incandescent lamplight at 2850 ± 100 Kelvin. The "US" marking shall conform to type IV, class 9 of DDD-L-20. The marking shall show "good" colorfastness to laundering transference; shall show "fair" colorfastness to accelerated laundering and shall be clearly legible after subjection to accelerated laundering The towels shall meet the end item testing requirements set forth in the tables below Testing shall be in accordance with FED-STD-191 or as detailed in the following tables·

Table V End Item Testing (Part 1)

Type	Dimensions (finished), inches		FED-STD-191 Test Method 5050 Yarns per inch minimum	
	Width 1/ ± 1/2 in	Length ± 1 in	Warp	Fill
I	16	27	2/	29
I	20	40	2/	29
I	22	44	2/	29
I	24	50	69	29
II	16	27	84	42
II	20	40	71	29
II	22	44	84	42

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Table VI. End Item Testing (Part 2)

Type	Dimensions (finished), inches		FED-STD-191 Test Method 5100 Breaking strength minimum pounds		Weight per doz , pounds minimum (conditioned) 3/
	Width 1/ ± 1/2 in	Length ± 1 in	Warp	Fill	
I	16	27	70	60	3.0
I	20	40	70	60	5.5
I	22	44	70	60	6.6
I	24	50	60	43	8.0
II	16	27	45	40	3 0
II	20	40	45	40	5 5
II	22	44	45	40	8 5

1/ Width inclusive of selvages or side hems
2/ For type I towels, the pile warp shall be 36 and the ground warp shall be 36.
3/ The towels shall reach equilibrium under Standard Conditions as defined in FED-STD-191 prior to determination of weight

Table VII. End Item Testing (Part 3)

Characteristic	Requirement	Test Method
Fiber Identification	cotton or polyester/ cotton	1/
Overall Fiber Content Type I, 24 X 50 in only	100% cotton	1/
Polyester content for ground warp and filling (except for Type I, 24 X 50 in)	70% maximum	1/ 2/
Discoloration (bleached towels)	The bleached towels shall show no more yellowing or discoloration than the standard sample after 20 hours exposure to light. When no standard sample is available, the discoloration shall be no more than the degree indicated as satisfactory when tested as specified.	5660 3/ 4/

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Table VII. End Item Testing (Part 3)

Characteristic	Requirement	Test Method
Presence of labile sulfur	The towel shall contain no more labile sulfur than that shown by the standard sample. When a standard sample is not available, the towel shall show not more than a slight trace of labile sulfur	2020
Colorfastness (when applicable) to:		
Laundering (after 3 cycles)	better than standard sample or "good"	5610 5/
Light	better than standard sample or "satisfactory	5660
Crimp in terry yarns	235% Minimum	4110 6/
Shrinkage	Warp - 10% Maximum Filling - 2% Maximum	5550
Weave	The cloth shall consist of warp and filling ground yarns and warp pile yarns, woven with a terry weave	Visual 4/
Nonfibrous material	The finished towel shall contain not more than 2.0 percent starch and protein content including chloroform-soluble and water-soluble material	2611
pH	5.0 - 8.5	2811

1/ Unless otherwise specified, a certificate of compliance shall be submitted and will be acceptable for the stated requirement.
2/ The polyester content shall be determined in accordance with the provision of MIL-C-43843.

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3/ Method 5660 shall be used, except that the exposure of the specimen and standard sample shall be for 20 Standard Fading Hours. Any specimen showing discoloration less than or equal to that of the standard sample shall be rated "pass". Any specimen showing discoloration greater than that of the standard sample shall be rated "fail". When no standard sample is available the discoloration of the specimen shall be considered satisfactory if it is not worse than the rating of "fair" in the scale indicated in Method 5660.
4/ One determination shall be made from each sample unit and the results reported as "pass" or "fail".
5/ The specimen must be dried after each of the 3 laundering cycles
6/ Method 4110 shall be followed except for the following:

a The original length shall be 2 inches in lieu of 10 inches in the test procedure.
b The jaw distance shall be set at 2 inches apart in lieu of 10 inches
c Calculation of results shall be based on a 2 inch length in lieu of 10 inches.

Preservation, Packing, and Marking The preservation, packing, and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order

OR

Packaging.

Overseas

Packaging Each towel shall be folded

Packing Sixty towels shall be packed in a fiberboard box conforming to style RSC-L, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

Source of Government Documents Copies of Military and Federal documents are available from:

Standardization Documents Order Desk
Bldg. 4D
700 Robbins Avenue
Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094

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Sources of Nongovernment Documents.

ANSI/ASQC Z1 4 - Sampling Procedures and Tables For Inspection By Attributes

(Applications for copies should be addressed to American National Standards Institute, 1430 Broadway, New York, NY 10018-3308.)

ASTM-D 3951 - Standard Practice for Commercial Packaging

(Applications for copies should be addressed to American Society For Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103)

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Towels, Bath, (Terry)

4 NATURE OF CHANGE *(Identify paragraph number and include proposed rewrite, if possible Attach extra sheets as needed)*

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